



EXHIBITION

Tale of Two Artists

Twin solo exhibitions at KNMA, Delhi, showcase the interesting parallels between the works of **Amitava** and **Mohan Samant**

IN HIS 1889 BOOK *Twilight of the Idols*, the philosopher Friedrich Nietzsche argued that "true experiences" cannot be adequately expressed in words. "Our true experiences are not garrulous," he wrote. "They could not communicate themselves if they wanted to: they lack words. We have already grown beyond whatever we have words for." That last line lends itself to the title of a 2011 work by Delhi-based artist Amitava, currently on display at the Kiran Nadar Museum of Art, Saket (Delhi), as part of twin solo exhibitions: Amitava's *If We Knew the Point* and Mohan Samant's *Magic in the Square*. These have been conceptualised by KNMA director and chief curator Roobina Karode and are open to the public till September 30.

Amitava's 'We Have Already Gone Beyond Whatever We Have' uses collage, gouache, opaque watercolours, correction pens and metallic paint markers on palm leaf paper. True to Nietzsche's words, the human figures at the heart of this work are rising in rebellion to the world around them. We don't know what exactly it is they are saying, as the

Common Thread

A new exhibition at Mumbai's 47-A showcases ***unique tales by 11 women textile artists*** from across India

MORE than 40 works of art; 11 women artists; a common motif of telling their stories through weaving, embroidery and installations. Recently opened at Mumbai's 47-A, *Feeling Through Fibre* presents a kaleidoscope of mediums, art forms, textures and colours. "The artists in this show come from across the country, using fibre to express what they feel. This is our shared connection. Each work will speak to you. Each work has a bit of the artist's soul," says curator and textile artist Julie Kagti.

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The 11 artists span multiple generations, from veterans like Jayshree Poddar and Shama Pawar to emerging talents like Akshata Mokashi and Rakhee Shenoy. The choice of mediums also varies, ranging from inherited vintage lace on muslin to indigenous yarns to cotton rag pulp—the latter is used to striking effect in Nivedita Deshpande's sculptural installation 'We Cannot See What Anyone Else Has Swallowed', which is an ode to spiders, nature's original weavers. Elsewhere, Pawar's 'Canopy of Emotions' is a natural fibre installation made in collaboration with artisans from Hampi. It's a testament to the resilience of nature and the potential for renewal, resonating with hope for the future.

Kagti, who learned weaving at the age of seven from her Assamese grandmother and years later chose to take it up professionally, has multiple pieces in the show, including several handwoven